KINGFISH ACE

Student guide · read the night before and the morning of

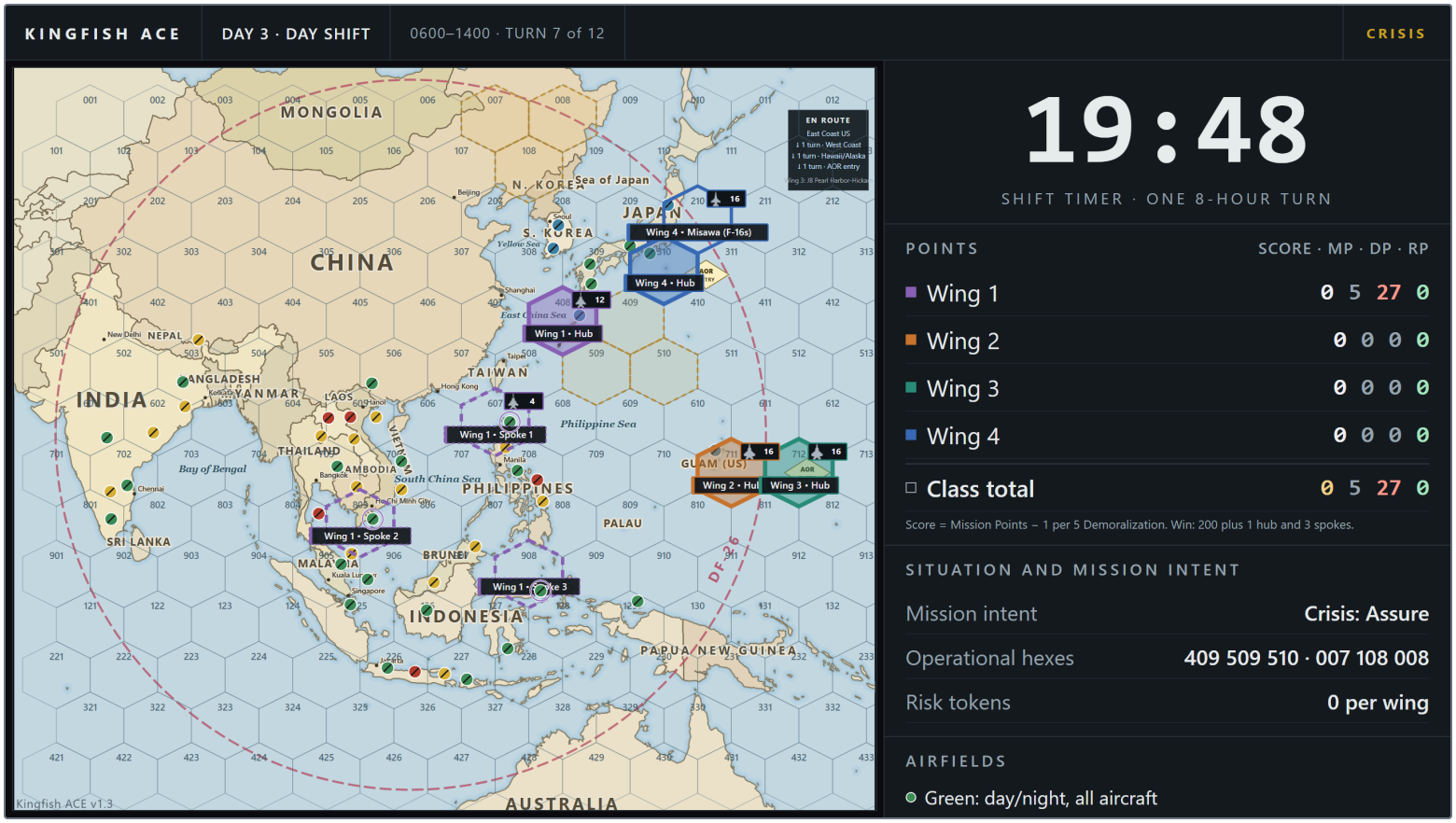
21A Maintenance Officer Intermediate Course · rules follow the Kingfish ACE rulebook (Lt Col Troy Pierce). C2IMERA reporting is not used.

Contents

Click any topic. Every page has a link back here.

1 The mission and how you win
2 Your team and your wing
3 Signing in
4 Reading the map
5 Upgrading a red or yellow airfield
6 The planning phase
7 Choosing your 3 spokes
8 Rolling your aircraft
9 RFIs: pick, then roll
10 Load plans: one chalk at a time
11 Plotting routes and moving
12 Requesting resources
13 The Resources page
14 Airfield tasks, IOC and FOC
15 Food, water, fuel and morale
16 Fighters: crisis and conflict
17 Situation, mission intent, risk tokens
18 Conflict: how Red attacks
19 A turn, step by step
20 Points cheat sheet
21 Your two days

1 The mission and how you win



Mission: establish adaptive cluster operations using Agile Combat Employment (ACE) to set conditions for success in the Indo-Pacific. Disperse to survive, then mass effects in line with strategic intent.

- Each wing keeps **1 hub** (its home base) and opens **3 spokes**.
- **Mission Points (MP)**: bring spokes to IOC, assess them, run combat turns and refueling, launch fighters.
- **Demoralization Points (DP)** count against you: every 5 DP costs 1 MP.
- **Resource Points (RP)**: 5 RP buys one resource chit.
- The projector shows each wing's score and the **class total**.

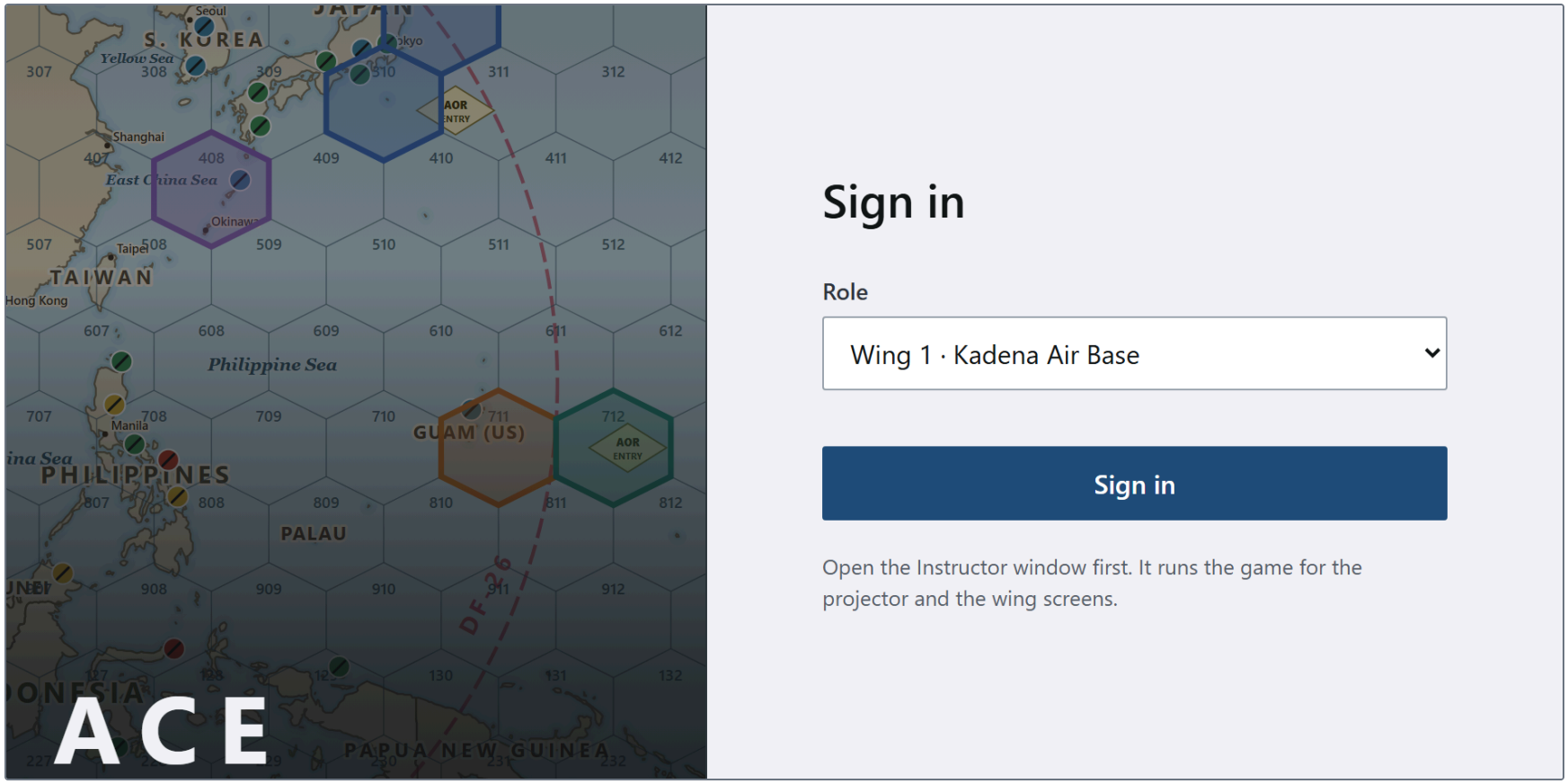
> **To win:** a score of 200 (Mission Points minus 1 per 5 Demoralization; a score never drops below 0) **and** 1 hub plus 3 spokes opened. (The rulebook says 100; this schoolhouse plays to 200.)

2 Your team and your wing

Wing	Home base (hub)	Fighters	What it is good at
Wing 1	Kadena Air Base, hex 408	16 F-15	Lead fighter wing, closest to the fight. Big munitions stocks, some missile defense. Light port, security and crash/fire rescue.
Wing 2	Andersen Air Force Base, hex 711	16 F-22	Large logistics and war reserve hub. Big munitions stocks, large security force and port.
Wing 3	Joint Base Pearl Harbor-Hickam (enters at 712)	16 F-22	Fighters plus a prepositioned Contingency Response Group: extra port, comms and security. No exportable missile defense.
Wing 4	Yokota Air Base, hex 310 (F-16s at Misawa, 210)	16 F-16	Mobility hub with extra port, comms and bed-down. Fighter support sits at Misawa.

Roles in each wing: a **Commander** (lead planner), a **Port** team (load plans and aircraft) and an **Airfield** team (RFIs, tasks, base status). Talk through the Commander once your people leave home station.

3 Signing in

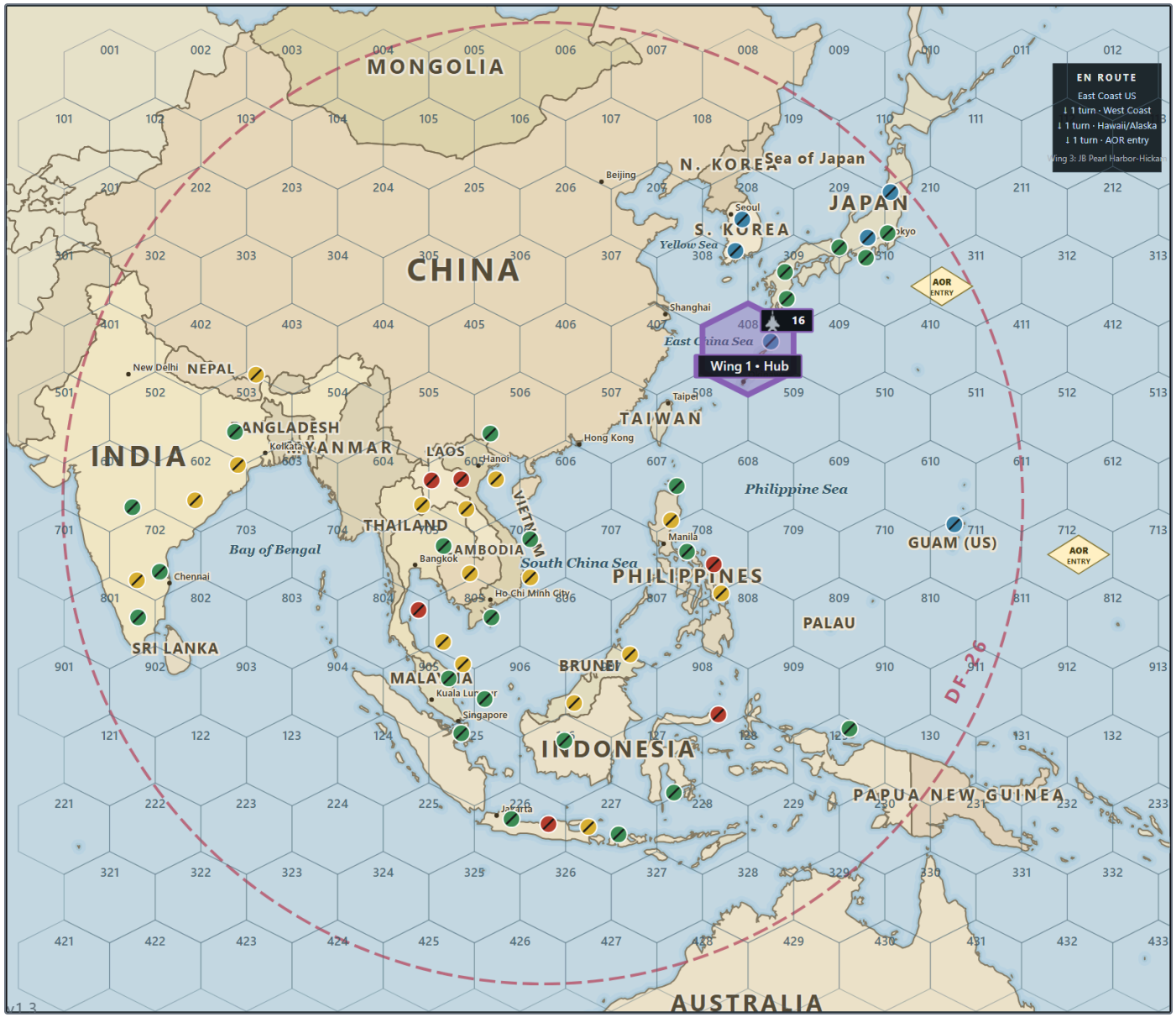


1. Open Kingfish ACE in **Microsoft Edge**. Your instructor sets up each wing screen.
2. Under **Role**, pick your wing (Wing 1 to Wing 4). Wings have no password.
3. Press **Sign in**.

- Two views at the top of your screen: **Hex map** and **Resources**.
- Four tabs on the right: **Plan** (named **Bases** once turn 1 starts), **Airlift**, **Fighters** and **Requests**.

Your screen shows only your wing. The instructor window must be open for the game to run. When you press **Roll**, the dice tumble on your screen and land on the result.

4 Reading the map

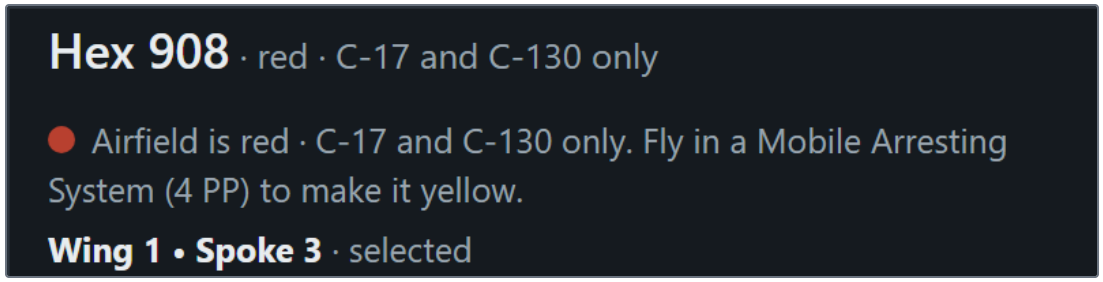


- Each hex is about **200 nautical miles** and has a number (for example 607).
- **Airfield dots:**
  green = day and night, all aircraft
  yellow = day only
  red = C-17 and C-130 only
  blue = main operating base
- A hex can hold more than one airfield.
- The dashed red circle is the **DF-26 ring**. Inside it, airfields can be hit by ballistic missiles in a conflict.
- Your bases show in your wing color: your **hub is a solid hex**, each **spoke is an outlined hex**. Click a base to see its name.
- Aircraft sitting at a base show as small badges with a count (for example a C-17 badge with 2). They fly their routes as the timer runs.

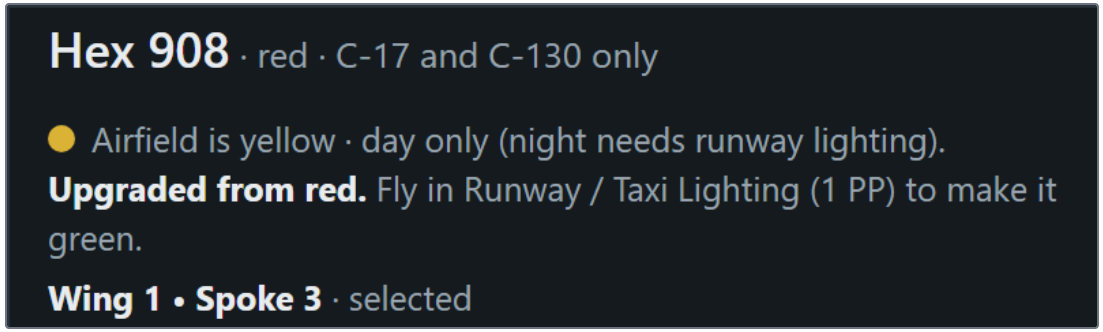
> Country borders matter: each day a country may grant or deny base access and overflight.

5 Upgrading a red or yellow airfield

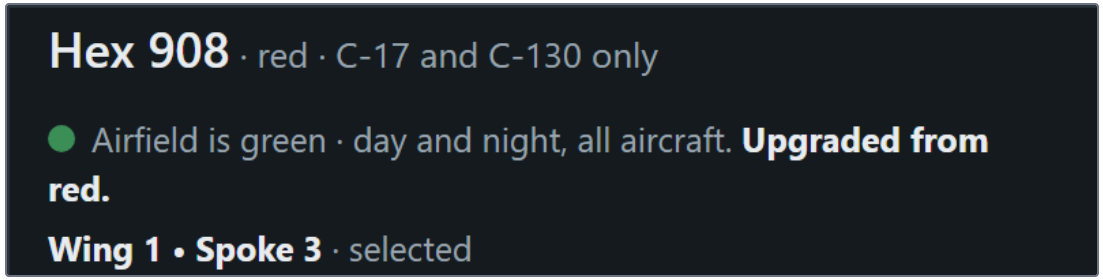
1. A red airfield as chosen



2. Mobile Arresting System on site



3. Runway / Taxi Lighting also on site

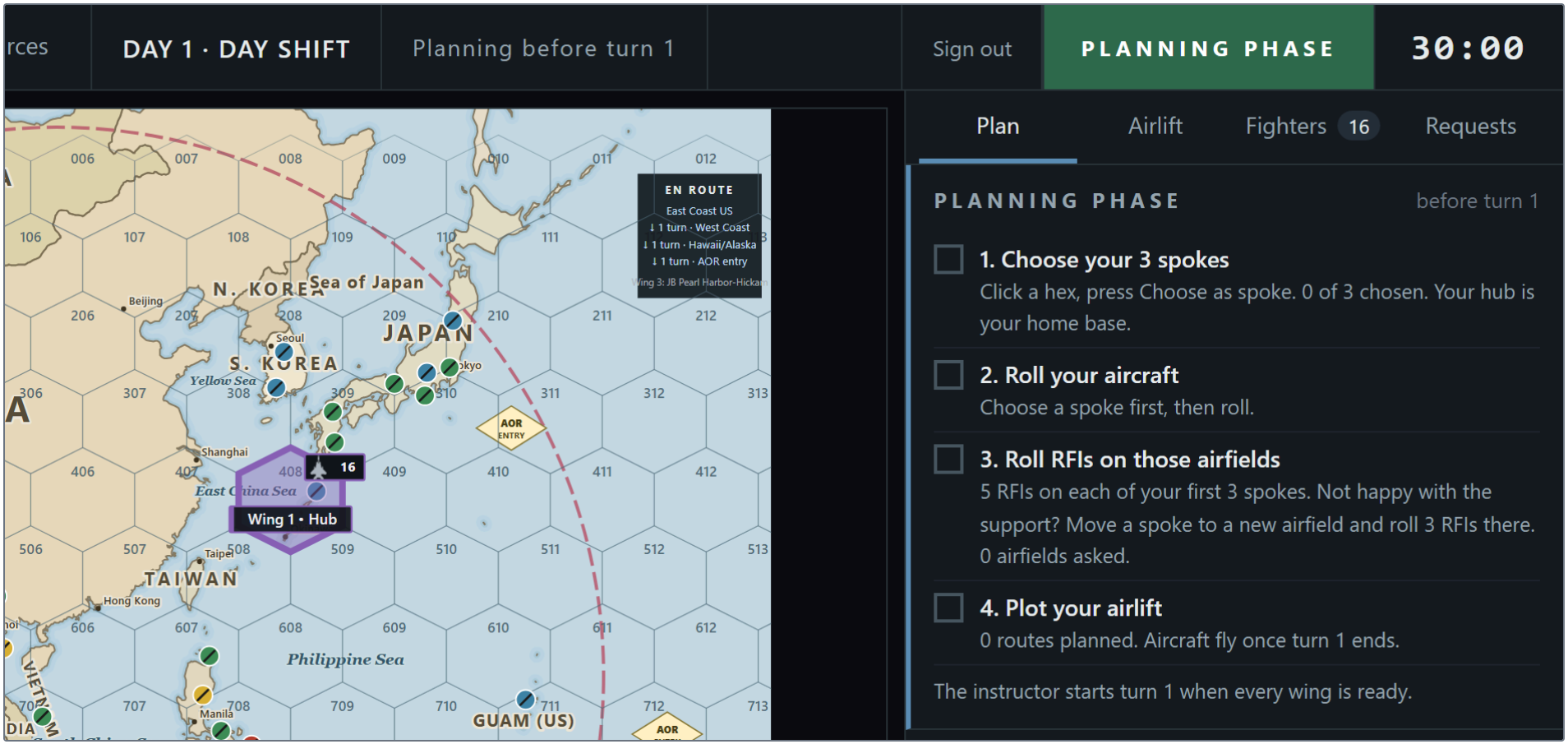


Airfield	Fly in	Becomes
red C-17 and C-130 only	Mobile Arresting System **4 PP**	**yellow** day only
yellow day only	Runway / Taxi Lighting **1 PP**	**green** day and night, all aircraft

1. Load the chip at your home station. Both are under **Mission Generation** in the load plan.
2. Fly it to the airfield. The color changes when the chip is on site.
3. Click the base. The panel and the Resources page state the current color and what is still needed.

> A red airfield needs both chips to reach green. The upgrade holds only while the chip stays on site.

6 The planning phase

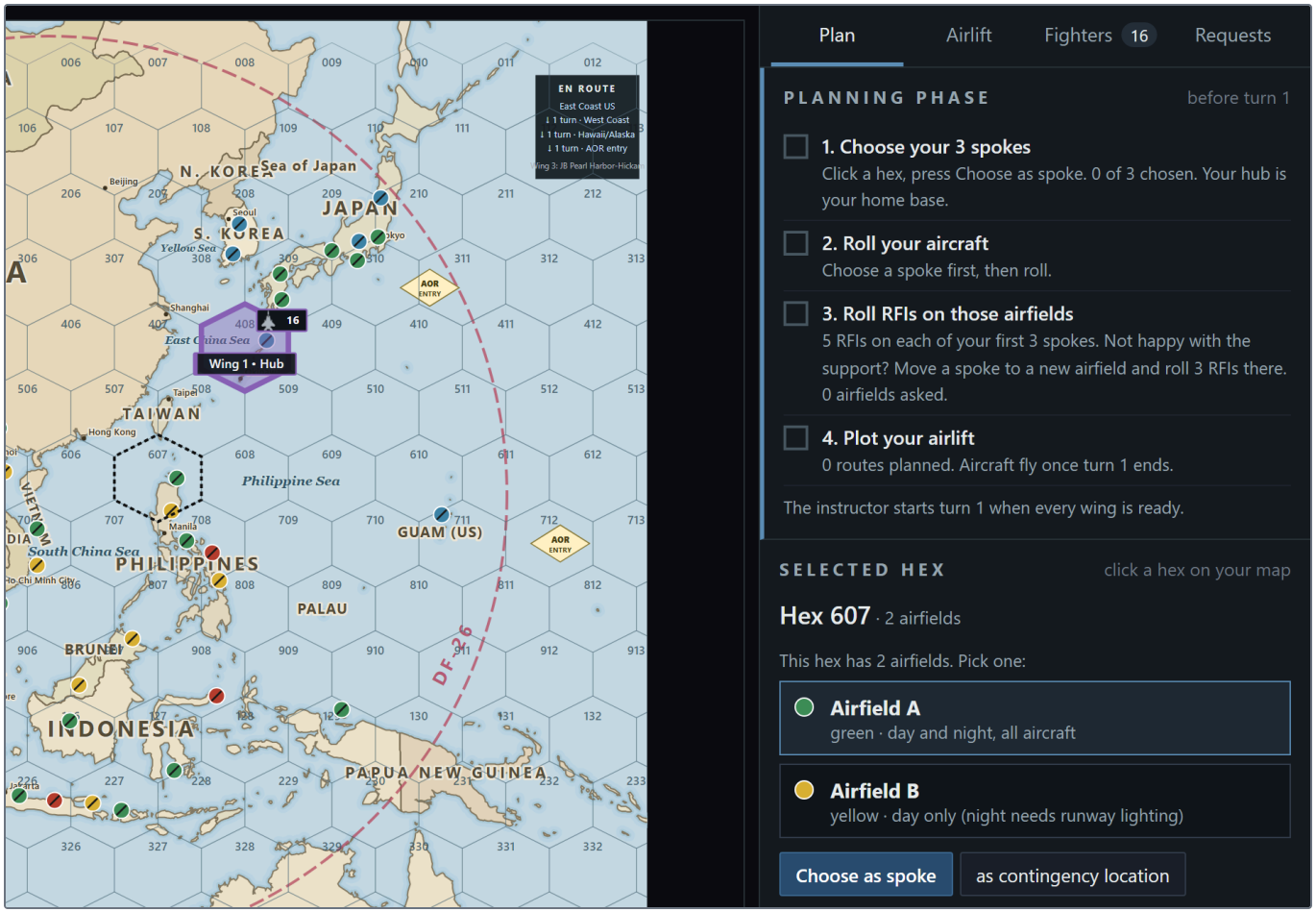


Before turn 1 you get a **30-minute planning timer**. The checklist on the **Plan** tab walks you through it.

1. Choose your 3 spokes.
2. Roll your aircraft. The button turns on once you have chosen a spoke.
3. Roll RFIs on those airfields.
4. Plot your airlift.

> Nothing is assigned for you. You make every choice. The instructor starts turn 1 when every wing is ready.

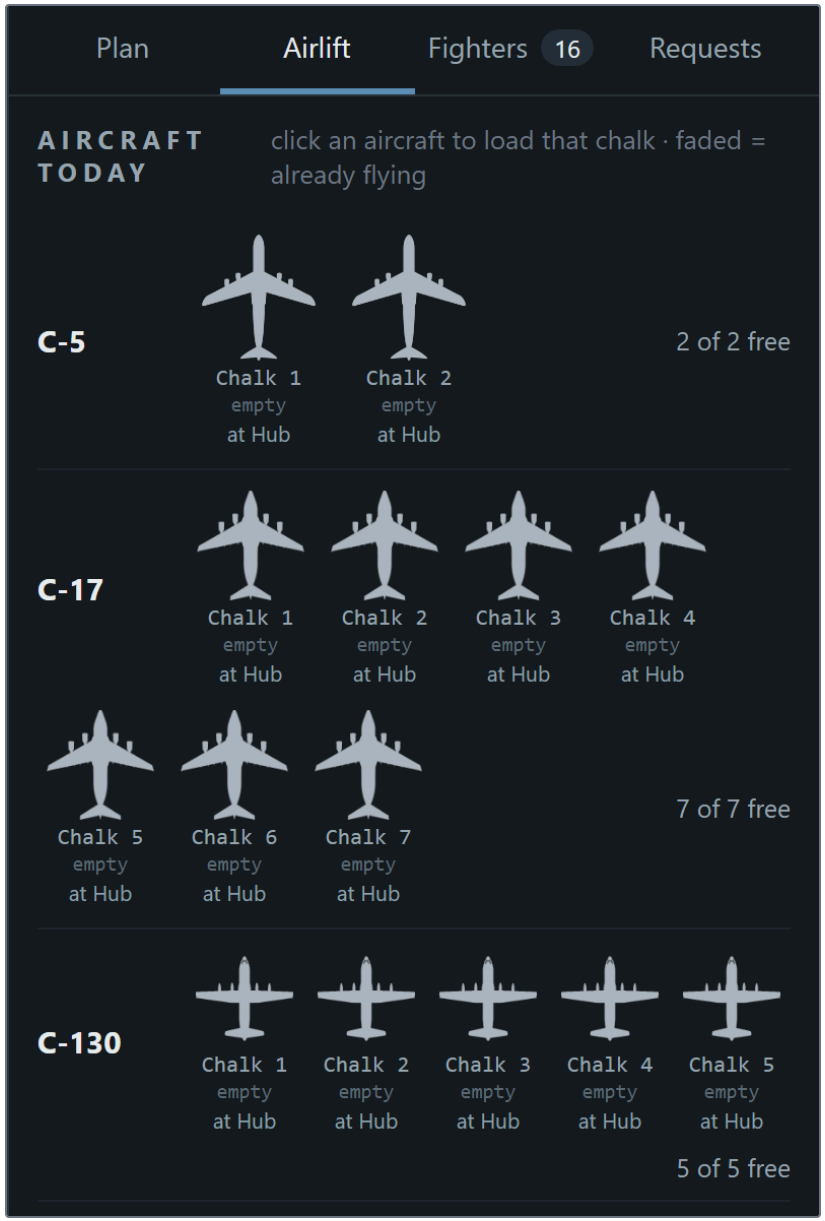
7 Choosing your 3 spokes



1. Click an airfield hex on your map.
2. If the hex has more than one airfield, pick **Airfield A**, **B** or **C**. Each shows its color.
3. Press **Choose as spoke** (or **as contingency location**).
4. The instructor approves it. It appears on the board as an outlined hex in your wing color.

- Your hub never moves. It is your home base.
- To move a spoke later, click the new airfield and press **move a spoke here**. Moves happen in the move window at the end of a turn.
- Chips you flew into the old spoke stay there until you fly them out.

8 Rolling your aircraft

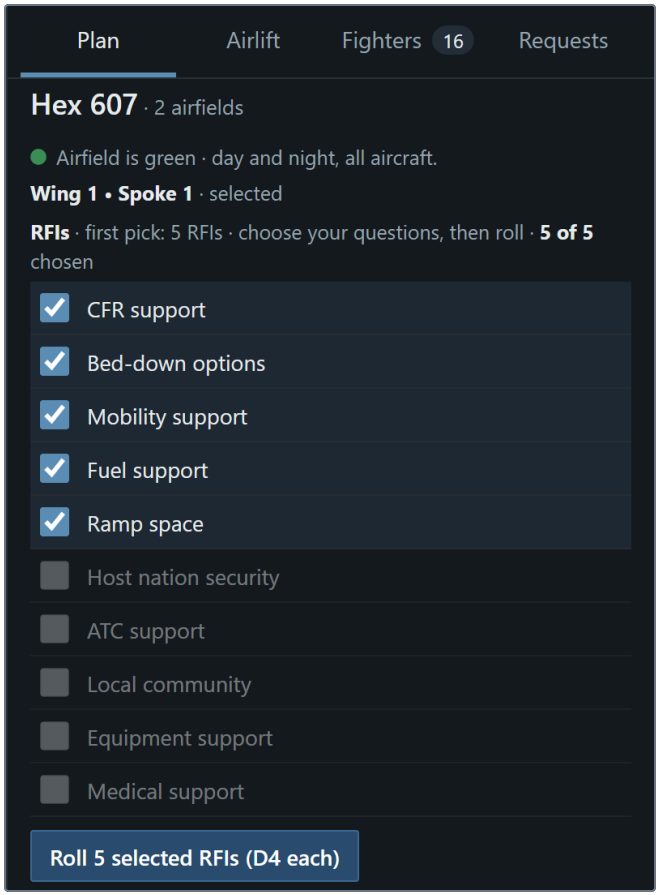


- Choose a spoke first. Then press **Roll aircraft**.
- Each day your wing rolls its own airlift: **C-17 on a D12**, **C-130 on a D12**, **C-5 on a D4**.
- The **Airlift** tab shows each aircraft as a **chalk**, numbered within its type: C-17 Chalk 1, C-17 Chalk 2, and so on.
- The number on the right shows how many are free, for example **7 of 7 free**.
- Under each chalk you see where it is: **at Hub**, **en route to** a spoke, or at a spoke.
- A chalk reads **empty** until you load it. A faded aircraft is already flying.
- An aircraft still in the air at the day change finishes its trip, then goes back. It does not count against the next day.

Aircraft	Cargo only	Mixed	People only	Moves
C-17	18 PP	11 PP + 54	102	4 hexes/turn
C-130	8 PP	2 PP + 62	128	3 hexes/turn
C-5	36 PP + 73		328	4 hexes/turn

9 RFIs: pick, then roll

1. Check your questions



2. Answers after the roll



1. Click the airfield. Check up to **5 RFI questions** (3 if you moved a spoke there).
2. Press **Roll selected RFIs**. Each gets a D4.

Answer	Means
1	No support. You must bring it.
2	Partial support (for example 1 tent, 1 fuel truck).
3	Full support. Some 3s complete tasks for you.

> Host nation support from your answers loads onto that base as chips. The **Ramp space** answer sets how many aircraft fit (1 C-130 / 2 C-17 / 6 C-17). When your people land, you can ask all remaining RFIs.

Rulebook: ask RFIs, pages 8–9 and 11

10 Load plans: one chalk at a time



1. On the **Airlift** tab, click one aircraft. The load plan opens for that chalk (for example **C-17 Chalk 1**).
2. Under **Load at**, pick the base you are loading from.
3. Add people, equipment and supplies with **+** and **−**.
4. Check the **Loaded** total, then press **Plot the route on the map**.

- The bar and the line under it show pallet positions (PP) and people used, for example **11 of 11 PP · 12 of 54 people**.
- Every chip shows its size (people per team, or PP for equipment and supplies) and how many are left at that base.
- If the aircraft is full, it tells you it is at **max capacity**.
- Chips working on a task cannot be loaded until you pull them off the task.

11 Plotting routes and moving

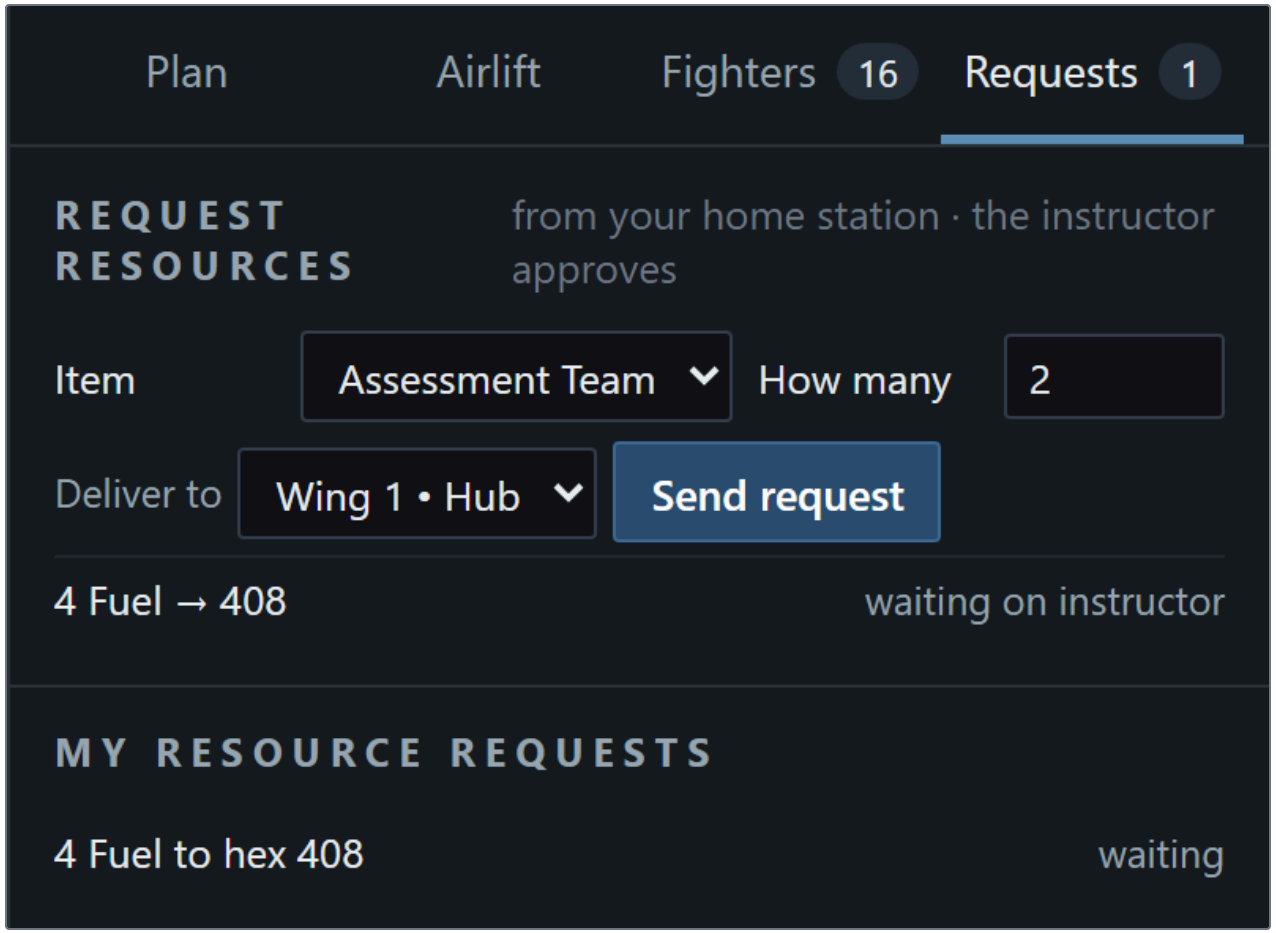


1. Press **Plot the route on the map**. The route starts at the base you loaded at.
2. Click hexes in order to the destination.
3. Read the checks. When each line says **OK**, press **Launch**.

- A close trip takes 1 turn. A far one takes 2 or 3.
- The aircraft flies its route on the board while the shift timer runs.
- The cargo lands at the end of the turn it arrives.

> The program blocks: an overloaded aircraft, a C-5 into a red field, more aircraft than you rolled, a full ramp (max on ground) and a struck airfield.

12 Requesting resources

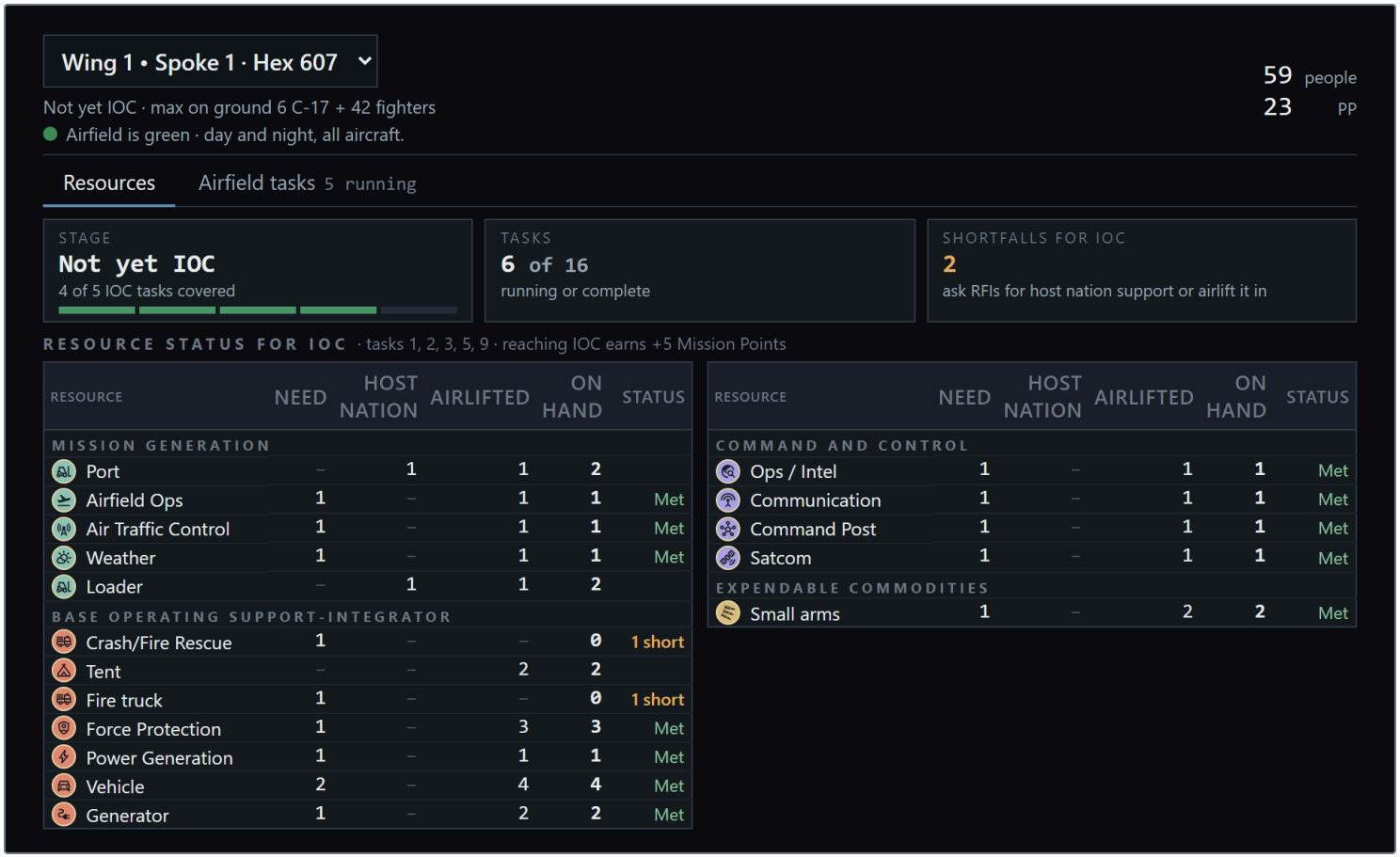


1. Open the **Requests** tab.
2. Pick the **Item** and **How many**.
3. Under **Deliver to**, pick your home station.
4. Press **Send request**.

- The request shows as **waiting** until the instructor approves or denies it.
- Approved items appear at your hub, ready to load.
- Common asks: fuel, food, water, bombs and missiles.

Rulebook: initial set up note, page 18

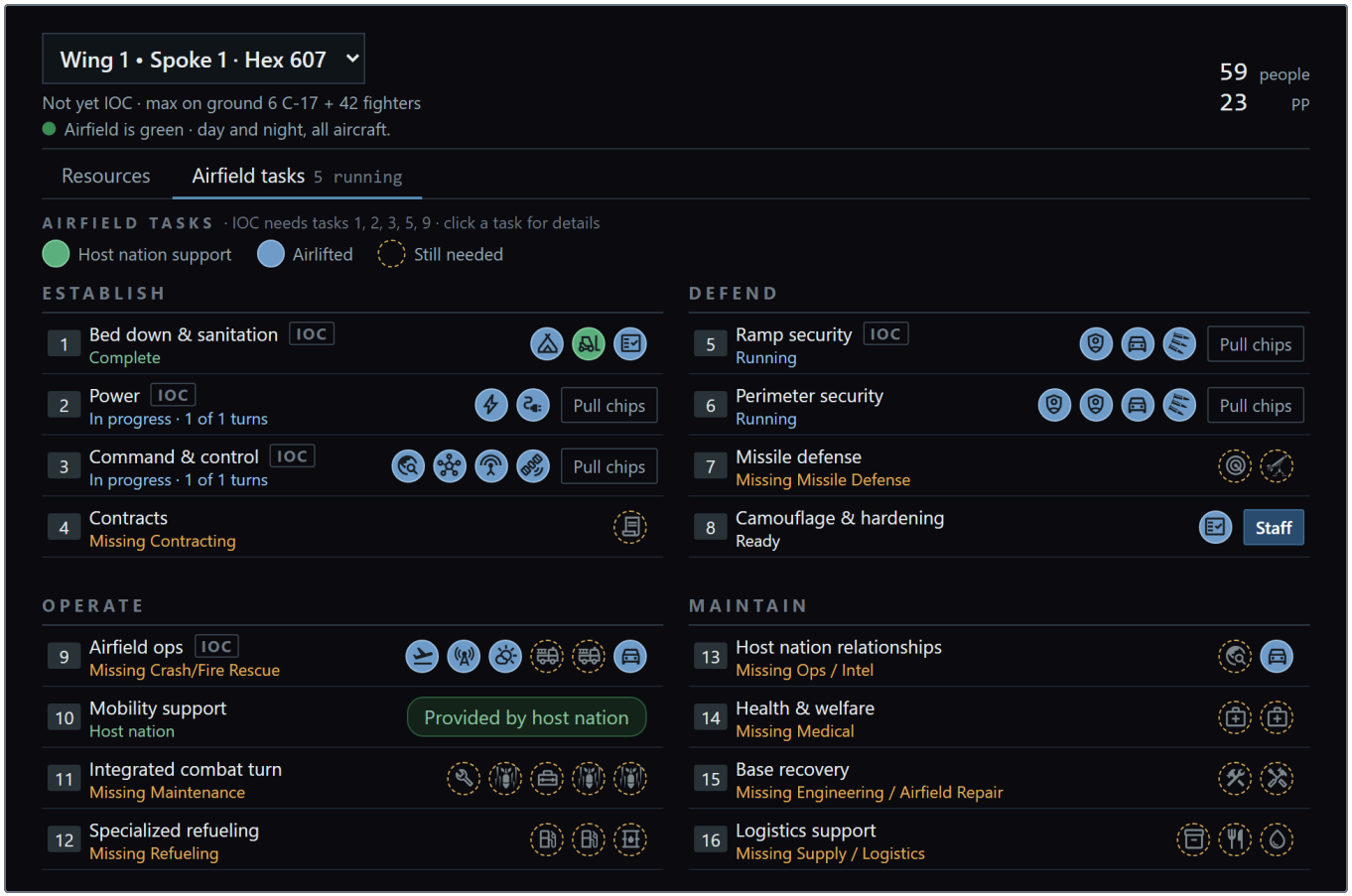
13 The Resources page



- Open **Resources** at the top of the screen. Pick a base from the dropdown (for example **Wing 1 • Spoke 1 · Hex 607**).
- The header shows the stage, max on ground, the airfield color, and people and PP on site.
- Three boxes: **Stage**, **Tasks** running, and **Shortfalls** for the next milestone.
- The two-column table lists every resource: **Need**, **Host nation** (from your RFI answers), **Airlifted**, **On hand** and **Status** (Met, or how many short).
- Cargo appears under Airlifted at the end of the turn the aircraft lands.

> A chip works one task at a time. If one Vehicle is on Ramp security, Airfield ops still shows a Vehicle short.

14 Airfield tasks, IOC and FOC



- On the Resources page, open the **Airfield tasks** tab. The 16 tasks sit in four groups: Establish, Defend, Operate, Maintain.
- Chips: **green** = host nation support · **blue** = airlifted · **dashed outline** = still needed.
- **Ready**: press **Staff**.
- **In progress** or **Running**: press **Pull chips** to free them.
- **Missing**: names the chip you need.
- **Host nation**: an RFI answer covers the task in full.
- The **IOC** tag marks the 5 tasks IOC needs.

Milestone	Tasks
IOC	1 Bed down, 2 Power, 3 Command and control, 5 Ramp security, 9 Airfield ops
FOC	11 tasks: 1, 2, 3, 5, 6, 9, 10, 11, 12, 14 and 16

Reaching IOC gives **+5 MP** for that spoke. **Integrated combat turn** and **Specialized refueling** each give **+5 MP every turn** they run. Fighters can launch only from a spoke running both.

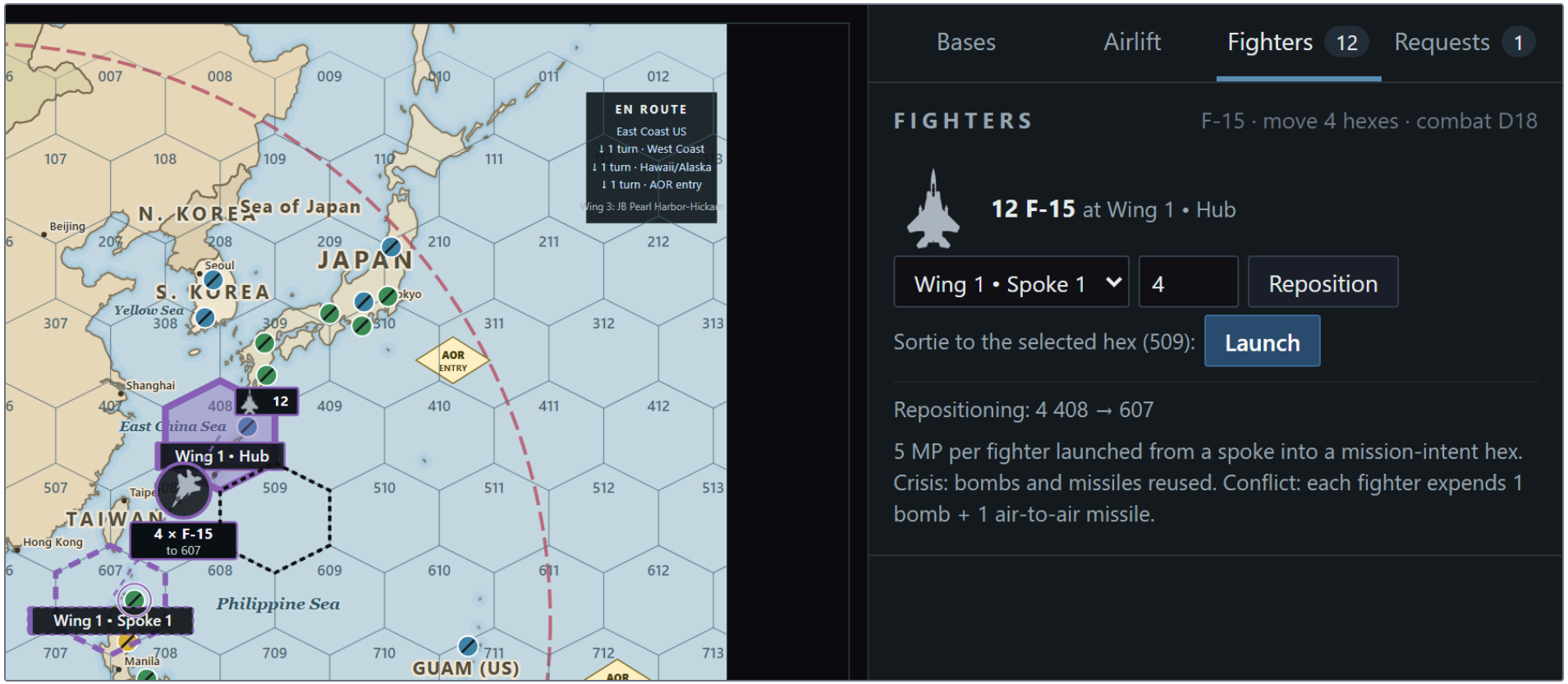
15 Food, water, fuel and morale

Rule	What happens
Logistics tax	At the start of each game day, every airfield with your people pays 1 food, 1 water, 1 fuel: every day with 50+ people, every other day with fewer. Home bases are exempt.
No food or water	10 DP the first day, 30 DP every day after. No DP at a struck airfield.
Too many people	Twice as many people as tasks use: roll D4 for DP. Three times: roll D10. Not checked at a struck airfield or where people landed that turn. At most 10 DP per wing per turn.
Competing priorities	A daily D10: below 5 you lose comms, a commodity, a host nation chip, or port support for a turn.

> Keep flying food, water and fuel forward. Put every person you deploy to work on a task.

Rulebook: pages 6 and 12; scenario card

16 Fighters: crisis and conflict

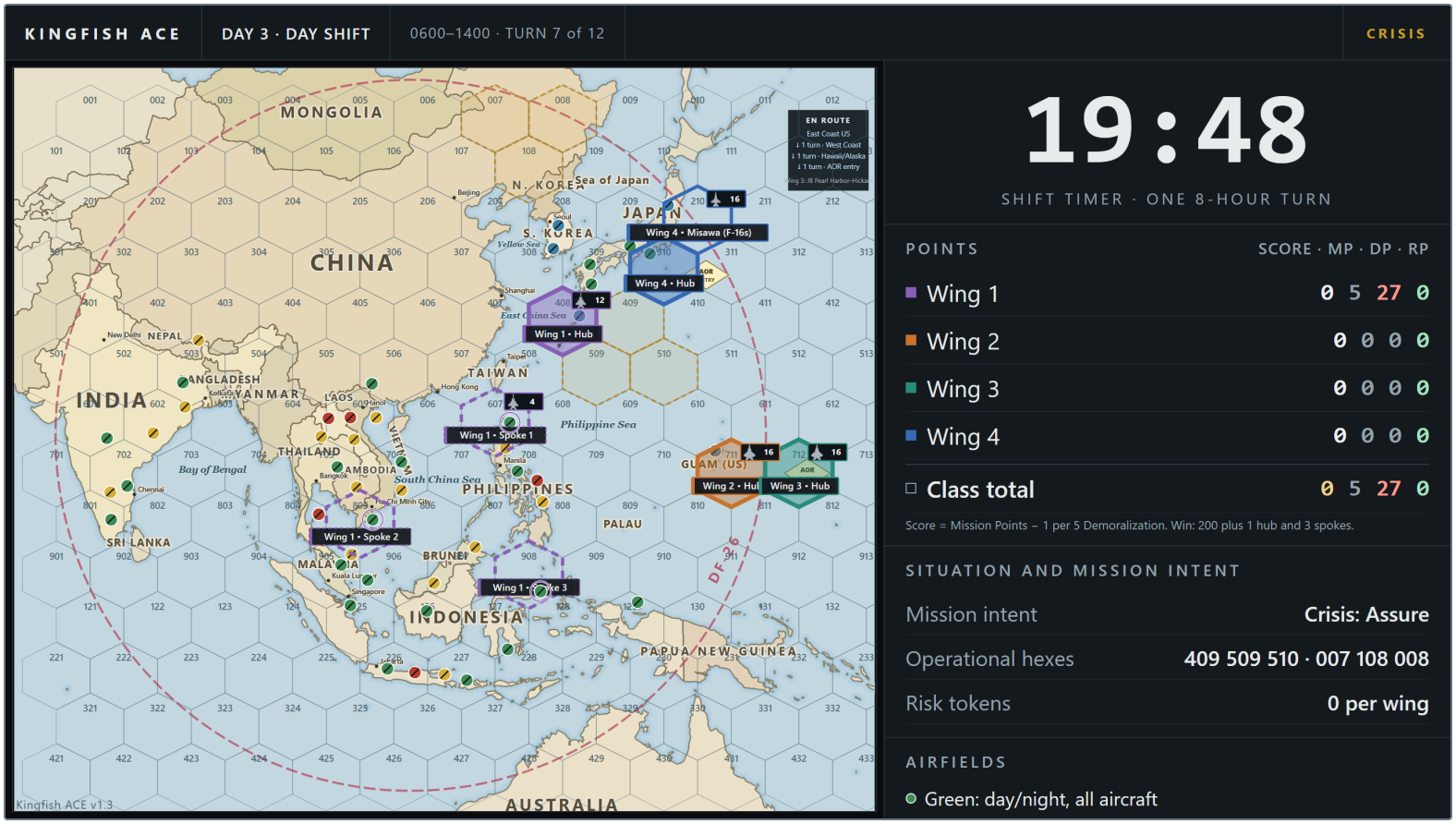


- Open the **Fighters** tab.
- **Reposition**: pick a base and a number. Fighters move up to 4 hexes and fly there on the board during the turn. The Ramp space RFI limits fighters on the ground (2, 7 or 42).
- **Launch**: click the target hex on the map, then press Launch. The sortie flies out to the target and back on the board. The spoke must be running its combat turn and refueling.
- **+5 MP per fighter** launched from a spoke into an operational hex.

	Crisis	Conflict
Munitions	Bombs and missiles reused	Each fighter uses 1 bomb + 1 air-to-air missile
Combat	None	Into a Red zone, one fighter at a time: your D18 vs the zone's die (D10, D12 or D20). Higher roll wins; a tie goes to Red. A losing fighter is shot down. The first win removes the zone and the rest fly home. A jammer nearby can add +2 to Red.

Rulebook: assign combat aircraft and resistance operations, pages 12–14

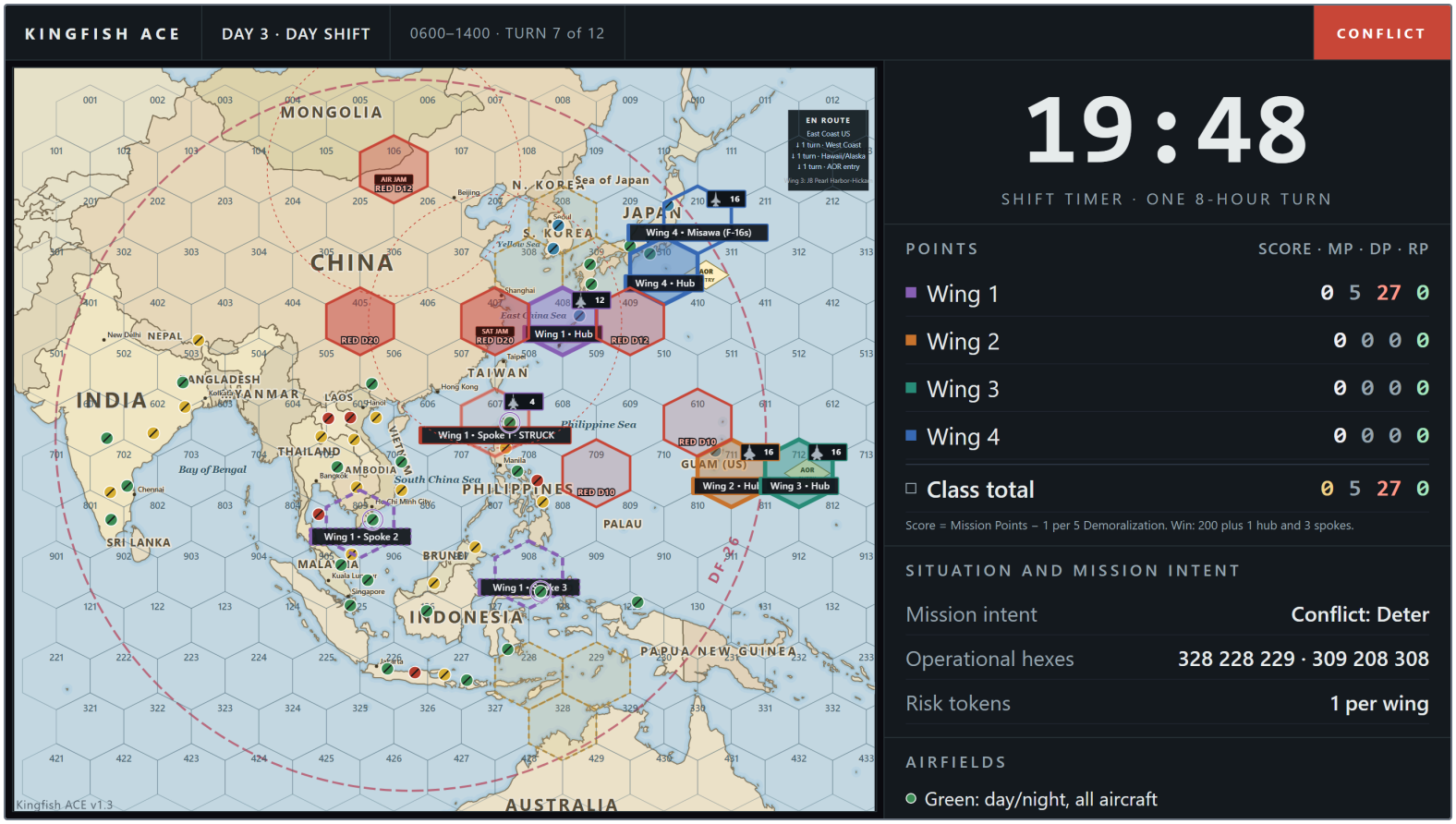
17 Situation, mission intent, risk tokens



- Each game day the instructor rolls a **D12**: crisis or conflict. Conflict gets more likely each day (Day 1: crisis on 1–10, Day 2: 1–8, Day 3+: 1–6).
- A **D4** picks the mission intent.
- The program marks **2 sets of 3 operational hexes**. Only launches into them earn MP.
- In a conflict the instructor places **6 Red zones** (2 Deep D20, 2 Air-land D12, 2 Farthest intercept D10) and 2 jammers.
- **Risk tokens** let your wing pitch an out-of-the-box move. Hand in one per activity.

Crisis	Tokens	Conflict	Tokens
Observe	0	Deter	1
Assure	0	Subdue	2
Shape	1	Compel	3
Persuade	2	Eradicate	4

18 Conflict: how Red attacks



1. **Intel warning:** D10 per spoke. Targeted above 7, 5, then 3 as its days of operation go up. **Hubs are never attacked.**
2. **Information attack:** jamming (within 2 hexes of a Red jammer) or cyber cuts your comms for a turn.
3. **Missile attack** (inside the DF-26 ring): instructor D20 vs your D10. Missile defense +2, hardening +1.

- A hit closes the spoke for **3 turns**, then it reopens. Aircraft cannot leave a struck spoke.
- A second hit restarts the 3 turns. A **third hit destroys everything** on the spoke. Aircraft flying to it turn back with their cargo.
- Your **home hub is never attacked**.
- There is no forced evacuation. Staying risks the next strike; moving is your call.

19 A turn, step by step

Step	Who	What happens
1. Start of day	Instructor	Situation, mission intent, base access. Wings roll aircraft.
2. Shift timer (30 min)	Wings	Pick and roll RFIs, load chalks, plot routes, staff tasks, reposition and launch fighters, request resources. Aircraft fly their routes as the timer runs.
3. End turn (instructor presses End turn; at 0:00 the game moves on by itself)	Program	Aircraft land and offload, tasks progress, points post, morale checks, and each wing is told which airfield its event and risk cards hit. Draw them from the decks.
4. Conflict only	Instructor	Run conflict phase: intel warning, information attacks, missile attacks.
5. Move window	Wings	Request spoke moves; the instructor approves.

> One turn = one 8-hour shift: Day (0600–1400), Swing (1400–2200), Mid (2200–0600). Each new game day also collects the logistics tax.

20 Points cheat sheet

Mission Points (+)	MP
Spoke reaches IOC (tasks 1, 2, 3, 5, 9), first wing there	+5
Assess an airfield (vehicle + assessment team on site)	+5
Integrated combat turn running, each turn	+5
Specialized refueling running, each turn	+5
Each fighter launched from a spoke into an operational hex	+5

Demoralization Points (−)	DP
A day without food or water (first day / each day after)	10 / 30
People 2× / 3× what the tasks use	D4 / D10

Score = MP − 1 for every 5 DP, never below 0. **Win** = score 200 and 1 hub + 3 spokes. Host nation relationships: +1 RP per turn; 5 RP = one resource chit.

Rulebook: scenario card and pages 6, 12

21 Your two days

When	What
Night before	Read this guide. Know your wing, how to win, and the planning checklist.
Morning of	Skim pages 6–11 again: planning, spokes, aircraft, RFIs, load plans, routes.
Day 1, first block	Watch the Kingfish ACE gameplay videos (the board game).
Day 1, next	Watch the Kingfish ACE program demo video (this software).
Day 1, setup (1 hour)	Sign in, then the planning phase: choose spokes, roll aircraft, roll RFIs, build load plans, plot first routes.
Game play	Turns of 30 minutes each: the shift timer runs 30 minutes; at 0:00 the game moves to the next turn on its own. In a conflict, the instructor runs the conflict phase before the timer ends.
End	Debrief: what you would change, and the attrition you would face in a real fight.

> Questions during play go to your Commander first, then the instructor.